

began to grow. Six years later, they were ready to start a family. Because Raj had greater earning potential, they decided he would continue to work while she would stay at home with the children. Before long, Katrina had her hands full raising three rambunctious boys. She took care of the house and found immense joy in being a mother, and Raj continued managing the family finances as he had always done. Everything was going well ... until it wasn't.

Something Katrina had always loved about Raj was his ability to dream big and get excited about things. But Raj's enthusiasm came at a cost: he was constantly coming up with ideas for striking it rich with some hare-brained business scheme. Katrina had always been the more practical partner; in the beginning, she was able to talk him down from his get-rich-quick delusions. But as she became increasingly involved with the kids, she lost track of what her husband was doing with their money. Unbeknownst to her, Raj had made some very bad investments.

It started when he bought some risky stock. One of the guys at work was going on and on about a mining company in Chile that was about to hit it big; he told Raj he'd be a fool not to invest. Never wanting to miss out on a good thing, Raj siphoned some money out of the couple's joint account. When Katrina noticed something awry on the bank statements, he lied and told her he'd needed the money to buy some materials for work. He got angry and accused her of not trusting him, so she swallowed her misgivings and said nothing. A few years later, he suggested they move into a bigger house. Katrina was skeptical, but Raj assured her he had done the math and that they could afford the increased mortgage payments and corresponding costs. She wanted to ask *how* they could afford it—Raj hadn't been given a raise in five years—but she bit her tongue, trying, as always, to be supportive. When they missed a house payment, she asked if she could go with him the next time he saw their financial advisor. He scoffed. "Don't be ridiculous, Kat. We can't afford to pay a babysitter for the kids just so you can keep an eye on me. That's fiscally irresponsible." So Katrina was silent.